



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Leman Academy of Excellence: Oro Valley
School Website: <https://lemanacademy.com/schools/arizona/oro-valley-k-8/>

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Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Leman Academy of Excellence, Oro Valley (K-8) presents a broadly classical framing in public-facing materials. It explicitly positions itself as a "classical education" school that emphasizes virtues such as wisdom and virtue, and aims to form the whole student (character, intellect, and the person). The public materials foreground formation of character and memory, with terms like "wisdom and virtue," "timeless values," and "character" recurring across pages. However, the site does not consistently disclose explicit traditional classical elements such as a stated Great Books program, explicit mention of grammar/logic/rhetoric (Trivium/Quadrivium), or a clear Socratic pedagogy across all grade levels in readily visible content. Taken together, the school aligns with many core classical signals but does not always meet all six element criteria in a fully explicit way.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Strengths: Clear emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and character; vocabulary of formation and a "classical education" frame; public materials describe a rigorous, values-driven program and small-class, personalized learning. Evidence of faculty and family partnership language that aligns with classical schooling ideals (e.g., "dedicated teachers," "safe, supportive environment," and "partner with parents"). - Evidence examples: "Leman Academy of Excellence in Oro Valley is a tuition-free public charter school serving scholars in kindergarten through 8th grade. Our classical education model builds a strong foundation of wisdom and virtue."; "Our curriculum builds both academic knowledge and character."; "Our teachers and staff at the Oro Valley campus are dedicated to creating a safe, supportive environment where every scholar can thrive." - Gaps to needle-move: Explicit Great Books/Great Conversation signals, explicit Trivium/Quadrivium framing, explicit Socratic pedagogy in upper grades, and explicit theology-liturgical language are less visible in the public-facing OV site. Increasing explicit articulation of those elements would move the school toward a more fully CLASSICAL profile. - Notable absence: Direct statements about Great Books, Great Conversation, grammar/logic/rhetoric as core curricular pillars, or explicit liturgical/theological practices are not readily visible in the cited OV content.

Abstracted takeaway: The school strongly frames education as formation with virtue, wisdom, and character at the center, and operates as a tuition-free classical program (K–8). It falls into SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to meaningful classical framing and formation emphasis, but would benefit from clearer, explicit articulation of canonical classical elements (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic pedagogy, liturgical-community practices) to achieve a CLASSICAL designation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a classical education that "builds a strong foundation of wisdom and virtue" and highlights timeless values as part of the school's foundational vision. This signals a teleology grounded in transcendent aims (virtue, wisdom) though the site does not foreground explicit theology, liturgy, or doctrinal worship.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: virtue, wisdom, timeless values. These map to the lexicon's positive signals for religious/metaphysical orientation (Virtue; Logos/Wisdom; permanent/permanent). - Negative indicators: none clearly present in the OV public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism signals, etc., in the visible text).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: virtue, wisdom, timeless values (3 mentions/functions mapped) - Negative keywords observed: 0 - Proportion: $3/3 = 100\%$ positive within the observed signals

Why this rating - The school foregrounds moral formation (virtue and wisdom) and a sense of the sacred dimension implied by "timeless values," but it does not present explicit theology, liturgical practice, or liturgical community life in the visible OV materials. This justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: OV text describing "classical education model builds a strong foundation of wisdom and virtue" and "timeless values."

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The OV materials frame education as formation of wisdom and virtue, not mere information, and describe the program as "classical education" that builds knowledge and character. This signals a telos oriented to human flourishing through virtue and wisdom. "Our classical education model builds a strong foundation of wisdom and virtue." and "Our curriculum builds both academic knowledge and character."
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Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: virtue, wisdom, character, formation (themes of formation and moral order present in text). - Negative indicators: none explicit.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: virtue, wisdom, character (plus formation as a conceptual tie-in; if counted, up to 3–4 signals) - Negative keywords observed: 0 - Proportion: approximately 100% positive among the explicit formation-related terms in the OV materials

Why this rating - The materials clearly articulate formation-oriented aims (virtue, wisdom, character), which align with Classical School Purpose and Goal signals. Absence of explicit counter-signals strengthens CLASSICAL orientation here.

Citations: OV phrases about forming wisdom and virtue; curriculum text about building knowledge and character. □filecite□turn0file0□turn1file16□

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The OV site emphasizes a classical framing and a robust curriculum, with sections for Curriculum and Reading lists, but explicit mention of the core liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) or Great Books/Great Conversation is not readily visible in the quoted OV materials. The site confirms a public charter K–8 with a focus on classical education and "whole-child" enrichment, but it does not consistently spell out Trivium/Quadrivium details or a Great Books program in the public-facing content. □filecite□turn0file0□turn1file16□

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: classical education framing, curriculum; reading lists; "Whole-Child Enrichment" (art, music, athletics) as part of a holistic curriculum. - Negative indicators present: explicit grammar, logic, rhetoric (Trivium) and Great Books/Great Conversation are not explicitly named in the visible OV content; no explicit Great Books program is described in the public-facing text.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: classical education; curriculum; reading list; whole-child enrichment (4–5 mentions mapped) - Negative keywords observed: explicit Great Books / Great Conversation; grammar/logic/rhetoric on the core curriculum (not observed in the visible OV text) - Proportion: approximately 4–5 positive signals vs 0–2 explicit classical curriculum signals; net effect leans TOWARD SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to partial alignment and missing canonical specifics

Why this rating - The school clearly operates under a classical education frame and emphasizes curriculum and character; however, the lack of explicit Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium and explicit classical pedagogy signals in the public materials yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: OV OV materials describing “classical education model” and curriculum emphasis; absence of explicit Great Books/Trivium signals in the visible OV text. [filecite\turn0file0\turn1file16](#)

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - OV content emphasizes a classical approach and a general pedagogy that centers on formation, but explicit references to Socratic seminars, dialogues, memory work, recitation, or chant (Scholé) are not clearly visible in the public OV content. The public materials discuss a personalized, small-class approach and a “living curriculum” vibe via teacher-student partnerships, but explicit Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy is not plainly described in the accessible OV content. [filecite\turn0file0\turn1file16](#)

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: classroom engagement, personalized learning, “small class sizes” that enable memory and relationship-building; references to a classical approach (implied pedagogy). - Negative indicators present: absence of explicit Socratic seminars, recitation, memory work, chant, or scholé on public-facing pages.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: personalized learning; small class sizes; teacher-student engagement; “classical” approach signals (4–5 signals) - Negative keywords observed: explicit Socratic/seminar language; memory work; chant; scholé (not visible) - Proportion: majority positive but lacking explicit classical pedagogy signals; ~60–70% positive relative to explicit signals in text

Why this rating - The school leans toward a classical pedagogy, with framing and a focus on formation, but the absence of explicit, canonical pedagogy signals (Socratic seminars, memory-based learning, recitation, etc.) in the visible content leads to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: OV statements about classical education, formation, and teacher partnerships. [filecite\turn0file0\turn1file16](#)

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - OV public materials describe a staff that is dedicated to a safe, supportive environment and to partnering with families. The faculty are presented as caring and committed; there is a visible emphasis on teachers as mentors and on the school community as a core element. The exact phrase “living curriculum” is not shown, but the sentiment aligns with the classical model’s emphasis on virtuous teaching and living examples.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: dedicated, caring teachers; staff as a core of the school; teachers as mentors guiding students; partnership with families. - Negative indicators: explicit “living curriculum” portrait of what a teacher should be and student should be (as a formal, defined phrase) is not visible in the OV public content.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: dedicated teachers; caring educators; partnership with families; staff and team language (3–4 signals) - Negative keywords observed: explicit “living curriculum” portrait and a formal teacher profile portrait language are not visible - Proportion: approximately 75% positive given the available signals

Why this rating - The faculty description signals strong classical orientation (mentorship, virtue, living example) but lacks explicit statements about a “living curriculum” or a formal teacher-portrait, so SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations: OV materials describing “dedicated teachers” and “caring educators.”

Element 6: School Parents and Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - OV materials show that families are central to the school experience and describe a partnership with families, with statements about small class sizes and family engagement. There is explicit mention of family involvement through partnerships with parents and a welcoming environment. The materials emphasize a community where “parents partner with teachers” and where families “choose” the school for its community-like feel.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: partnership with parents; family involvement; welcoming community; co-ownership of student success. - Negative indicators: explicit, formal “parent as co-teacher” language or structured parent formation programs (e.g., book studies, parent seminars) is not clearly described on the visible pages.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: partnership with parents; welcoming community; families choosing OV; co-engagement signals (3–4 signals) - Negative keywords observed: explicit “parents as co-teachers” language or formal parent-education formats are not visible - Proportion: approximately 70–75% positive in the observed signals

Why this rating - The OV site demonstrates robust parent involvement and a welcoming community, aligning with classical signals for Parent & Community; however, the most explicit “co-teaching” or formal parent-education programs are not clearly described in the visible public content. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Citations: OV site language about families choosing OV, partnership language; “Families in Oro Valley choose our campus ... strong relationships formed with caring educators.”

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 3 (Curriculum): Add explicit, public articulation of canonical classical curriculum components, such as:
 - Clear statements about grammar, logic, and rhetoric as core curricular strands (Trivium) and about the Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) as applicable at specific grade levels.
 - Explicit commitment to Great Books and the Great Conversation (or a formal list of core works) in the curriculum documentation.
 - Publicly publish a reading list aligned with Great Books and primary sources across grades.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Publicly commit to and describe explicit pedagogical methods aligned with classical education, such as:
 - Socratic seminars in upper grades, narration/recitation in appropriate grade bands, and the use of memory work and catechesis where relevant.
 - Documentation of “Scholé” or contemplative days and a structured rhythm of study that balances rigor with contemplation.
- For Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a formal teacher-portrait framework and living-curriculum concept:
 - Provide a public “Portrait of a Classical Teacher” and a “Living Curriculum” articulation showing how teachers embody and enact virtue, wisdom, and classical pedagogy.
- For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand explicit parent-formation and co-teaching language:
 - Create and publicize parent-education offerings (book studies, seminars, and liturgy-based family activities) and emphasize visitor-friendly campus policies to welcome parent involvement as co-educators.

These needle-moving steps would largely shift the profile from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward fully CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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